

Samsung Galaxy M14 5G

Standout budget 5G smartphone

Does the newly launched Samsung Galaxy M14 5G revolutionise the sub-₹15,000 smartphone market? That's the question I set out to answer, and you will get a definitive answer through my review of the Samsung Galaxy M14 5G.

BUILD AND DESIGN

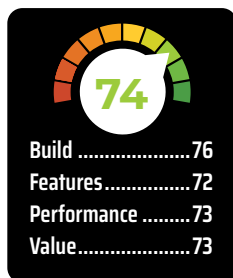
Now, it would be wrong of me to say that this device looks premium through and through. No, it doesn't. What you are getting here is an acceptable design that is reminiscent of Samsung's more premium offerings, primarily due to the camera module design. The glossy panel on the M14 attracts fingerprints and smudges galore. Despite this, the minimalist design looks classy and chic, in my opinion. A clear case would also help mitigate the fingerprint issue while retrieving the overall look of the phone. The phone is comfortable to hold due to the rounded edges, but it is quite thick at 9.4 mm.

DISPLAY

The Samsung Galaxy M14 5G's PLS LCD panel can't compare to AMOLED panels which some other phones at this price point offer, one example being the Realme 10. Additionally, the teardrop notch and the large chin bezel really impact how immersive the display feels. The display is bright enough though. Indoors, I tested the screen using a lux meter and got a reading of 421 nits at maximum brightness, and got a reading of 865 nits outdoors under sunlight, which is decently bright and legibility in sunlight is satisfactory as well. I found that the Adaptive Brightness feature tends to set the brightness too low when indoors at all times. The display has natural colours and good detail, however, the viewing angles are mediocre. The 90 Hz refresh rate allows for smooth scrolling



₹14,990



between screens, when reading articles, and on social media.

PERFORMANCE AND UI

The Exynos 1330 processor performs extremely well in most scenarios but there are instances where I faced a bit of stutter and lag when using the phone.

This is with the 6 GB variant, mind you. The Samsung Galaxy M14 5G comfortably beat all the Redmi Note 12, Infinix Note 12 Turbo, Moto G42, and Realme 9i 5G in CPU tests such as AnTuTu, GeekBench, and PCMark Work. I also ran GPU benchmarks on the phone, and the Galaxy M14 5G performed decently well. Next, I ran the CPU Throttling Test and the phone throttled to only 82 per cent of its peak performance after 15 minutes of the test. Now, I also tried gaming on this phone and through my experience, I can say that this phone is not for hardcore gamers. The overall performance is quite impressive at this price. Samsung has also promised two years of OS updates and four years of security updates – which is quite decent.

CAMERA

The Samsung Galaxy M14 5G's triple rear camera setup almost feels like a downgrade. I tested out all these cameras

extensively and was generally appreciative of the results, especially at this aggressive price point. The primary camera takes detailed pictures in daylight with good colour and contrast. When there's harsh lighting in the background, shadows get crushed but the highlights are still kept in check. Focussing via the 2 MP macro lens is decent though, not as bad as we've seen on some other 2 MP macro cameras at this price. In low light, the primary camera struggles to preserve detail and the shots taken have a fair bit of noise. The selfie camera clicks very good pictures in daylight with natural-looking skin tones and good detail retention. Portrait images from the selfie camera also have decent edge detection. However, in low light, you will see some noise starting to creep in.

BATTERY LIFE

In our 4K video loop test, the Samsung Galaxy M14 lasted for a whopping 18.5 hours on a single charge. The M14 comes with 25 W fast charging support and I recorded a charging time of 1 hour and 22 minutes to take the battery from 0-100 per cent, which is pretty decent.

VERDICT

The Samsung Galaxy M14 5G has a trifecta of strengths – battery life, performance, and camera. However, it does miss out on some essentials – a charger in the box, an AMOLED display, and an ultrawide camera. All that aside, for those who want a budget 5G phone with dependable performance and an excellent camera, I would be more than comfortable recommending the Galaxy M14 5G.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Exynos 1330 | Manufacturing Process: 5 nm | GPU: Mali-G68 MP2 | Display size and type: 6.6-inches, PLS LCD | Display resolution: 1080 x 2408 (FHD+) | Refresh rate: 90 Hz | Cameras (rear): 50 MP primary + 2 MP depth + 2 MP macro | Camera (front): 13 MP | OS: Android 13, One UI Core 5.1 | RAM: 4/6 GB | ROM: 128 GB, expandable up to 1 TB | Battery capacity: 6,000 mAh | Weight: 206 g

CONTACT

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